

3-Way Client Session Manager

User Guide (v1.0)

1. Overview

The **3-Way Client Session Manager (3-Way CSM)** is a Windows desktop utility that centrally manages SSH/SFTP sessions and launches one of three external clients:

- **Tera Term** (SSH with optional macro support)
- **PuTTY** (SSH)
- **WinSCP** (SFTP)

The application does **not modify** these third-party tools. It simply launches them with the correct command-line parameters.

Key goals:

- Store frequently used session definitions in a single manager for 3 clients
- Optional auto-login with saved credentials
- One-click launch into SSH or SFTP
- Optional Tera Term macro selection
- Simple backup rotation of session data

Notes:

Sessions are stored inside the %APPDATA%\teraterm5\ folder so Teraterm **MUST** be installed before 3-Way_CSM can be used! PuTTY and Win SCP are add-on options that may share the same manager.

2. System Requirements

Operating System

- Windows (32-bit or 64-bit; tested paths suggest Windows 10/11)

Required External Programs

At least **one** of the following must be installed:

- **3-Way_CSM**
 - Default path:
 - `C:\Accessories\3-Way_CSM`
- **Tera Term (*Mandatory before use*)**
 - Expected paths:
 - `C:\Program Files\teraterm5\ttermpro.exe`
OR
 - `C:\Program Files (x86)\teraterm5\ttermpro.exe`
- **PuTTY**
 - Searched in:
 - Application folder
 - `C:\Program Files\PuTTY\putty.exe`
 - `C:\Program Files (x86)\PuTTY\putty.exe`
OR
 - portable sharing the same 3-Way_CSM folder
- **WinSCP (portable only)**
 - Expected default:
 - portables sharing the same 3-Way_CSM folder

If a client is not found, its option is automatically disabled in the UI.

3. Installation

****The 3-Way CSM executable fully expects TerraTerm is pre-installed.****

1. Place the **3-Way CSM executable** in its own folder (recommended).
2. Ensure TeraTerm client is installed. Sessions are stored in the %appdata%\teraterm5 folder
3. (Optional) Place `putty.exe` in the 3-Way_CSM folder.
4. (Optional) Place `WinSCP.exe` in the 3-Way_CSM folder.
5. Launch the application.

△ Only **one instance** of 3-Way CSM is allowed. If already running, the existing window will be brought to the foreground.

4. Main Window Layout

Left Pane

- **Session List**
 - Displays saved sessions
 - Format:
 - Name, IP_Address, Port [TAB] encrypted_password [TAB] encrypted_username

Right Pane

- **Client Selection** (only one allowed)
 - ☐ Tera Term
 - ☐ PuTTY
 - ☐ WinSCP
- **Session Fields**
 - **Title** – Friendly session name
 - **Address** – IPv4 numeric IP address
 - **Port#** – Defaults to 22
 - **UserName** (optional)
 - **Password** (optional)
- **Controls**
 - [SAVE]
 - [CONNECT]
 - [ping]
 - [Sessions Folder]
 - [?] Help
 - [About]

Notes:

- Ctrl-C anywhere in the IP address field copies the address:port to clipboard.
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5. Creating a New Session

1. Enter:
 - **Title**
 - **Address**
 - **Port** (optional, defaults to 22)
 - **UserName** (optional)
 - **Password** (optional)
2. Enable **[User/Pswd OK]** if you want credentials saved.
3. Click **[SAVE]**.

Notes

- If **Title** Already exists the record will be modified when saved. If **Title** is new, a new session will be created when saved.
 - If **User/Pswd OK** is unchecked, credentials will **not** be saved.
 - Sessions are updated if the session name already exists.
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6. Connecting to a Session

Method 1: Button

1. Select a session from the list.
2. Click [CONNECT].

Method 2: Keyboard

- Select a session and press **Enter**.

What Happens

- Depending on the selected client:
 - **PuTTY** launches `SSH session`
 - **Tera Term** launches SSH session with selected optional macro
 - **WinSCP** launches using an `sftp session`
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7. Client-Specific Behavior

PuTTY Mode

- Uses SSH2 only
- Password auto-login only works if **User/Pswd OK** is enabled.
- Window title includes session name and IP.

Tera Term Mode

- Uses SSH2 only
- Password auto-login only works if **User/Pswd OK** is enabled.
- Window title includes session name and IP.
- Automatically scans for `.ttl` macro files at launch in:
%APPDATA%\teraterm5\
 - Macro files appear as radio buttons when TeraTerm mode is selected.
 - [CLEAR] button deselects all macro radio buttons.
 - [Edit] button displays the selected ttl macro file in a dedicated edit window.
 - Selected macro is passed when new session is launched.
Can be used for automating tasks with carefully designed TTL macro scripts.
Links to help documentation are provided on the about window.
- SSH2 Session can be opened with optional password auto-login enabled.

WinSCP Mode

- Uses SFTP only.
 - Creates/updates `winscp.ini` with defaults if needed.
 - Credentials are passed via URL when allowed.
 - SFTP Session can be opened with optional password auto-login enabled.
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8. Password Handling

- Session specific Usernames and passwords can be optionally stored with each session.
- Credential storage is **encrypted**, not stored in plain text.
- Saved credentials are only used to support **auto-login** when launching supported clients.
- Credential use is controlled by the **[User/Pswd OK]** checkbox:
 - **Enabled:** credentials may be saved and passed automatically to the selected client.
 - **Disabled:** credentials are not used for auto-login and must be entered manually.

Password Visibility

- The **[Show Password]** option temporarily reveals or masks the username and password fields in the UI.
- This affects display only and does not change how credentials are stored.

Security Notes

- When auto-login is enabled, credentials are passed to the selected client, which performs the actual network authentication.
- All connections are handled directly by the selected third-party client (Tera Term, PuTTY, or WinSCP).
- Users remain responsible for securing access to the workstation where session data is stored.

Best Practice:

Use auto-login only on trusted systems and disable **[User/Pswd OK]** if manual authentication is preferred.

9. Session Storage & Backups

Sessions are stored in:

%APPDATA%\teraterm5\Sessions

Automatic Backup Rotation

On every save:

1. Sessions → Sessions1
2. Sessions1 → Sessions2
3. Old Sessions2 is deleted

This provides **two generations of rollback**.

10. Managing Sessions

Delete a Session

1. Click a session in the list.
2. Press **Delete** on the keyboard.

Edit a Session

1. Click the session.
2. Modify fields.
3. Click **[SAVE]**.

Beware:

Modifying the **Title** will result in new session creation. If you must modify the **Title** then you must remember to manually delete the old session.

11. Ping Test

- Click **[ping]** to test reachability.
 - Uses Windows `ping.exe` with one packet.
 - Displays success/failure message.
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12. Sessions Folder Button

- Opens File Explorer and highlights the active `Sessions` file.
 - Useful for backups or manual edits.
 - This is Also where the `.ttl` macro files are expected for TeraTerm.
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13. Help Window (?)

Provides:

- Usage instructions
- Explanation of **[User/Pswd OK]** checkbox
- Session file rotation details
- Link to TermTerm macro documentation

Press **any key** to close the help window.

14. About Window

Includes:

- Version information
- Legal disclaimers
- Hyperlinks to:
 - Tera Term homepage, help documentaion & license
 - PuTTY homepage & license
 - WinSCP homepage & license

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15. Balloon Tips

- Balloon Tips can be turned on and off (default is on).
 - All Guiding popups including Balloon tips can be disabled by modifying the program shortcut. Place a space followed by **/quiet** after the target name to disable all guiding popups.
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16. Known Limitations

- TeraTerm Macros Selection is limited to 8 total
 - IPv6 not supported
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17 Intended Use

This tool is ideal for:

- Network administrators
- Support technicians and engineers
- Lab environments
- Gateway (Jump) Server